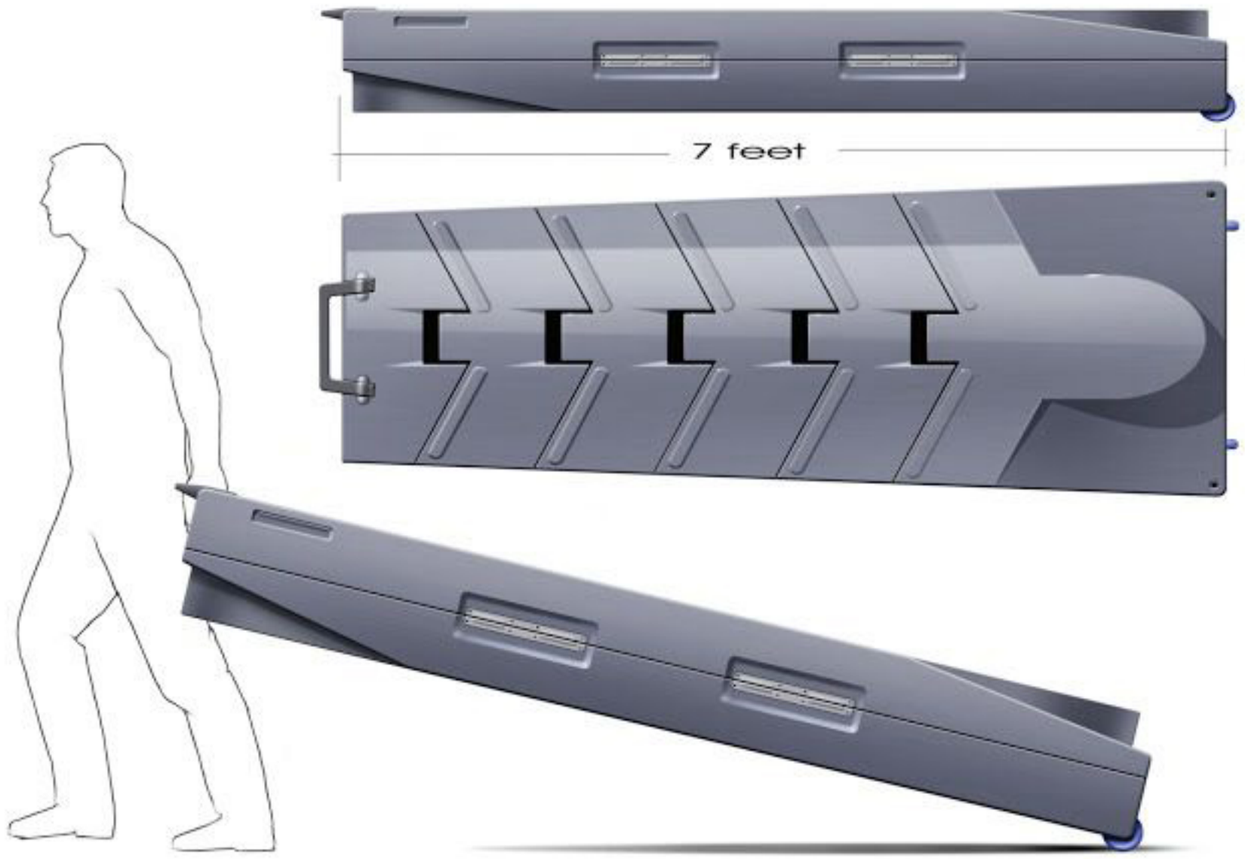
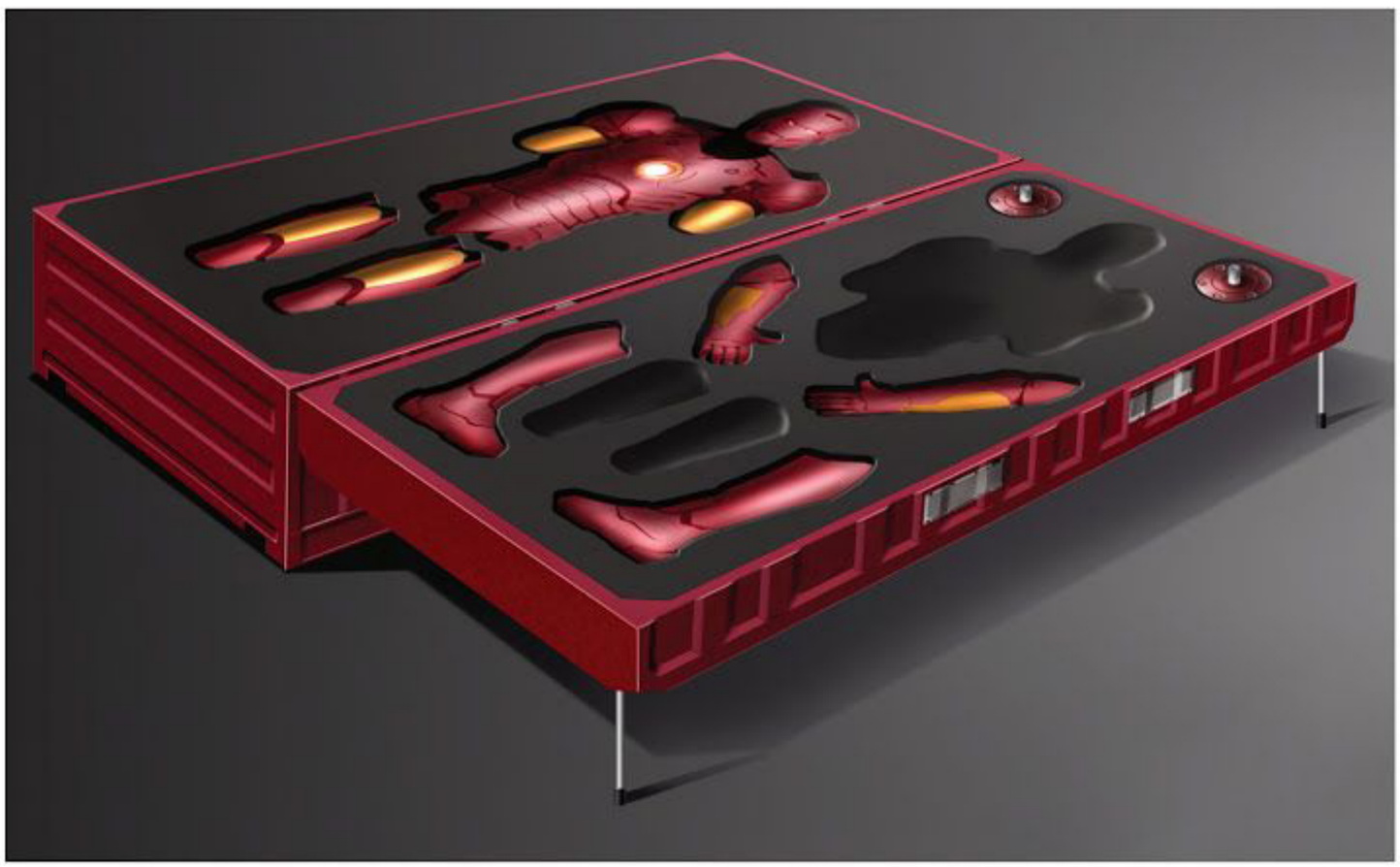




Page 92: Armor suitcase designs (Ron Mendell)

Page 93: Armor suitcase designs (Harald Belker)

One of the original conceits of the Iron Man comic book was that Tony Stark would carry around his armor in small segments stored in a suitcase, the better to protect his identity while still having the armored power of Iron Man at his fingertips. It also helped solve the problem of placing Iron Man in far-flung locales where the hero might have difficulty flying under the power of his repulsor technology. Phil Saunders ushered this idea into the creative process of the movie. Though he didn't work directly on it, he monitored the progress of the suitcase all the way through, even though it didn't wind up coming to fruition. Unlike the early simplicity of the comic-book suitcase, this 21st-century armor attaché would have to be some heavy duty equipment in both form and function!

SAUNDERS: "We came up with an idea of having a suitcase that was almost like an ammo case or a steamer trunk that would open itself up hydraulically. It would open up with these bars above Tony's head. He would grab onto the bars, lift himself up, lower himself into the pants, and then they'd seal up on him. Now he'd be standing in the pants, he'd reach up into the torso section that would be hanging above him, and then that would seal down over him like a watch band. Then he would put on each of the arms that would attach over the shoulders, and then the ribcage section would clamshell over him, and then finally he'd put on the helmet and gloves and be done."